

Socialist Party Wales Manifesto 2026



Standing as part of the

WELSH
TRADE UNIONIST AND
SOCIALIST COALITION



Socialist Party Wales manifesto for the 2026
Senedd elections



For socialist change in Wales

Introduction

Socialist Party Wales is standing candidates for the Senedd as part of the Trade Unionist and Socialist Coalition (TUSC) to provide a real alternative for working workers, youth, students, pensioners, and communities. We need socialist champions in the Senedd for the working class who will stand up for its interests.

Every time there is a crisis its working class people who pay the price

Capitalism is a system in permanent crisis. The latest crisis will follow on from the US attack on Iran. Every time it is the working class and the public services that we rely on that are made to pay the price. But what remains constant is the huge levels of profits that billionaires continue to make – no cuts for them.

The Welsh government under Labour has dutifully carried out the cuts to public services demanded by the UK government of whatever stripe and behind them the demands of big business in the City of London.

Already our services have undergone 16 years of austerity – that have left vital services hanging by threads.

It is clear that both Labour and Plaid Cymru are incapable of defending working people in Wales from those cuts.

Under Labour control the Welsh NHS has seen cut after cut – hospitals closed and services reduced. The cuts have been so severe that we have the lowest number of intensive care beds per capita in Western Europe – our NHS has buckled under the strain.

A Welsh government under Plaid Cymru would be no different – just look how Plaid-led councils have cut local services in Gwynedd and Carmarthenshire.

And unfortunately the Green Party leaders refuse to pledge to not carry out cuts either. In Scotland they have been coalition partners in a government of cuts

We need socialist members of the Senedd who will hold the parties of austerity to account. Reform will certainly not do that – those Thatcher-supporting-Tories favour even deeper cuts.

TUSC members of the Senedd will stand up and fight these cuts. They will represent the interests of working people in the Senedd. They will speak up for the working class – opposing real pay cuts or job losses.

Socialist Party Wales standing as part of the Trade Unionist and Socialist Coalition (TUSC) has a manifesto for the Senedd elections which could make a real difference. Even one MS taking a stand, if they used their position in the Senedd chamber to appeal to those outside, could give confidence to local trade unionists and community campaigners to campaign for social justice.

A socialist group in the Senedd could make a huge difference even in those areas not devolved from Westminster. If the Senedd had made a clear statement opposing disability cuts, for example, and refused to co-operate with them it would have added enormous pressure on the Starmer government.

But above all we are campaigning for a new mass workers' party – bringing together working class people in the trade union movement, community organisations, tenants associations and campaign groups in a new party to fight for the working class.

Socialists are standing to fight for a real programme of reforms:

Public spending cuts

Since the last Senedd elections in 2021, the Labour-led Welsh government has dutifully passed down public sector cuts, consistently demanded by the Tories in Westminster, and now continuing under the Starmer government.

The NHS across Wales remains in terminal crisis, education is not much better, and local government continues to make millions of pounds more council cuts whilst above inflation council tax increases are still the norm.

We need Senedd Members who will enthusiastically work alongside local councillors, trade unions and community campaigners to stop further cuts, improve our public services, protect council jobs, services, and pay a minimum wage of at least £15 an hour.



TUSC Senedd Members will link up with trade unionists to ensure that NHS workers, like the Cwm Taff health visitors, receive their proper pay grade instead of being forced into strike action against the health board management and the Labour health minister, who could both resolve this dispute overnight.

We will be working alongside the education unions in Wales to stop further staff redundancies and improve the conditions and working environment in the underfunded, dilapidated schools.

And our Senedd Members will demand that local councillors must oppose all cuts and closures to council services, jobs, pay and conditions.

We will oppose council tax, rent and service charge increases, by demanding adequate funding from central government to maintain and develop our public services.

For those councils who continue to implement cuts, we will launch a campaign amongst council workers, trade unions, and residents for legal, no-cuts, needs budgets

in order to force the Westminster and Welsh governments to provide the finances necessary to protect all of our local government services.

Over the past five years many public service jobs in Wales have been privatised in Wales, outsourced to either 'social enterprise' or 'arm's length' management organisations, which are the first step towards full privatisation. All these services must be brought back in-house now.

Our public sector in Wales needs protecting, improving and fully financed.

Socialist Senedd Members would play a vital role in achieving that objective.

- Opposition to all cuts and closures to public services, jobs, pay and conditions. We reject the claim that 'some cuts are necessary'.
- Refuse to carry out further cuts to public spending
- Reject income tax, council tax, rent and service charge increases for working class people to make up for cuts in funding and demand the UK government restores the cuts in funding it has imposed.
- Support a “needs budget” for Welsh public services that outlines what our communities and services need to end poverty and fight for the resources to carry them out
- Vote against the outsourcing, privatisation of public sector jobs and services, or the transfer of council services to 'social enterprises' or 'arms-length' management organisations, which are first steps to privatisation. Bring all services back “in-house”.

Fighting poverty

According to the Joseph Rowntree Foundation, 22% of people in Wales live in poverty including 200,000 children.

Urgent action is needed to tackle low pay, unemployment and poverty.

Despite the limited powers of the Welsh Government, a number of policies can be implemented and fought for.



- Free school meals for all school aged children in Wales
- A minimum wage of £15 an hour with no exemptions
- Ban compulsory zero hour contracts and casualisation of employment
- End the use of bailiffs for council tax debt collection

NHS

Under Welsh Labour governments dozens of hospitals have been closed. The number of beds since 2008 have been cut by 21% which means that Wales has the lowest number of intensive care beds per person in western Europe – lower even than NHS England under the Tories.

And NHS staff need to be supported and retained. Incredibly, newly-trained Welsh paramedics are being turned away and told to find jobs abroad, while patients wait hours for an ambulance. NHS health visitors are having to take strike action to be placed on the correct pay band. And health professionals are leaving the NHS in droves, worn down by overwork and stress.



- Reverse all cuts to the NHS since 2010
- Restore the loss of hospital beds
- A crash training programme to train doctors and nurses – promise every medical student, nursing student and medical professional student free education and bursaries in exchange for a promise to work in the Welsh NHS for ten years
- Expansion in the number of ambulances and paramedics available to reduce emergency waiting times
- A&E provision to be returned to local hospitals and the number of intensive care beds returned to the pre-austerity levels.
- End privatisation of NHS services and nationalise the pharmaceutical and NHS supply industries

Employment rights

TUSC supports the trade unionists fighting for workers' rights and for a new mass workers party where the trade unions play a central part.

Labour has significantly watered down the Employment Rights Act after lobbying by big business, so that workers in Wales still face some of the most repressive anti-union laws in the western world.



Employers will be free to continue the exploitation of their workers by using zero-hour contracts and fire and rehire.

Wales is already a low wage economy with the value of wages dropping significantly through Tory austerity passed on by Labour in the Senedd and the cost-of-living crisis. All the establishment parties including Plaid Cymru and Reform will try and make working class people pay for the crisis of capitalism.

Socialist Senedd members will fight for:

- All Welsh government contracts and grants to be restricted to companies that respect ethical employment practices and health and safety regulations including trade union rights

and campaign for the Senedd Government to demand the Westminster Government enact the following:

- A £15 an hour minimum wage with no exceptions, for minimum wage to automatically increase linked to average earnings or inflation, whichever is higher.
- Employment rights from day one

- All workers to have trade union rates of pay. All wages to increase at least in line with prices.
- Ban zero-hour contracts and an end to insecure working and full- time work for all who want it.
- Immediate repeal of all anti-trade union legislation.

Climate Change

Most parties are offering platitudes to oppose climate change, but only TUSC is proposing a socialist green new deal that can prevent carbon emissions and ensure a just transition to a green economy that protects jobs.

We oppose the idea that workers' jobs and working class living standards should be made to pay for the climate emergency created by big business.



And while energy prices go through the roof for working class families the privately-owned energy companies make hundreds of billions of pounds profit.

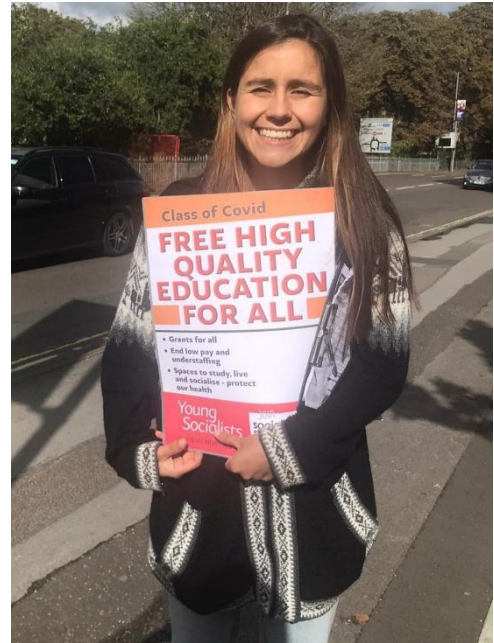
For a socialist Green New Deal:

- Invest in tidal lagoons at Swansea Bay, Cardiff and North Wales
- Take the steel industry into public ownership and invest in green steel at Port Talbot to protect jobs
- Electrify Welsh railways
- Massively expand access to free, publicly-owned public transport
- Nationalise the energy companies in order to lower prices and carry out a major switch to clean, green energy, without any loss of jobs, pay or conditions.

Education

All levels of education have been underfunded in Wales which has meant larger and larger class sizes, cancellation of courses and over-worked education workers. TUSC calls for:

- Publicly-provided nursery care to be available to all children in Wales
- Extended maternity leave
- More outdoor teaching areas in primaries – stop the sell off and building on school playing fields
- Limit teachers' workload
- Further education colleges to be brought back under local authority control
- No class sizes over 20 through the employment of extra teachers
- Education is a right – not a privilege so university tuition fees should be scrapped and a grant paid to allow students to study without having to work through uni etc.



Transport

Bus and train fares in Wales have gone through the roof, while the private bus companies make big profits.

To allow people to reduce car use we need a free, extensive and integrated public transport system.



Public transport in Wales should be publicly-owned and democratically run. The Welsh government should fight for the investment needed to bring our railways into the 21st century:

- The permanent renationalisation of rail and buses including the rail infrastructure and for an integrated public transport system
- For free public transport to make it affordable and encourage people to use cars less

Housing

A growing housing crisis in Wales is leading to rising homelessness and overcrowding.

Tenants need lower rents and security. People should not have to pack up all their possessions and move every six or 12 months. For families it is even worse - children have their education disrupted by constantly changing schools. Secure tenancies with fair rents would allow people to stay in their homes so long as they paid the rent and did not damage the properties.



The Covid crisis showed that decisive action could be taken by the Welsh government and councils that could provide instant solutions. For example, why not re-introduce the scheme that housed the homeless during the lockdown and banned evictions and make them permanent?

- Re-introduce the scheme to house the homeless
- Re-introduce fair rents – rent control that would put a ceiling on rents in each area through the return of rent tribunals.
- Secure tenancies for private tenants. No fault evictions must be made illegal.
- For a mass council house building programme on an environmentally sustainable basis, to provide good quality homes with affordable rents
- Support the Acorn manifesto.
- Nationalise the large housing companies, and take over empty properties.

Tackling racism and discrimination

We believe everyone should have equal rights regardless of their race, ethnicity, religion, gender, or sexual preference.

The cost-of-living crisis, low wages and high rents, the collapse of public services - these are the results of funding cuts and privatisations carried out by Tory and Labour governments, the Labour-led Senedd, and local councils run by every major party.



Faced with widespread anger and frustration at plummeting living standards, capitalist politicians of all stripes - including but not limited to Reform - have attempted to shift the blame onto asylum seekers, transgender people and other vulnerable minorities.

They want to divide the working class so we are fighting each other instead of uniting to fight for decent living standards for all.

Socialist Party Wales calls for a united working-class fight for jobs, homes and public services for all, against racism and division. We need maximum unity to launch effective struggles in defence of our jobs, homes, and services.

- Defend the right to asylum.
- End police harassment. For the abolition of the Criminal Justice Act. No curtailment of jury trials.
- Oppose the attacks on trans rights and the Supreme Court ruling. Yes to self-ID
- Fight to end discrimination on the grounds of race, sex, sexuality, disability, age, and all other forms of prejudice.



Disabled rights

Austerity has hit disabled people the hardest because of the cuts to public services, social care and benefits.

Socialist Party Wales believes everyone should have equitable access to employment, housing and public facilities:

- Stop disability cuts. For a Welsh Government that stands up for disabled people.
- Enshrine disabled people's rights in Welsh law, devolve welfare to Wales, and deliver a robust long term Disabled People's Rights plan, designed, monitored and delivered by fully resourced and democratic Disabled People's Organisations and workers' organisations.
- End institutionalisation. Support independent living and a genuine choice over access to mainstream or specialist education.
- Support in full the demands of the Welsh Disability Rights Taskforce, Welsh Disabled People's Organisations and Welsh carers' organisations
- Immediately introduce a Carer's Allowance Supplement, as was introduced in Scotland in 2018. Kick for-profit providers out of social care - for a publicly owned Welsh National Care Service democratically controlled by care workers and service users.

Language

- The Welsh and English languages to have equal legal rights. All major companies which provide services to the public to provide choice of use of Welsh language.
- No discrimination against workers who initially can only speak English. Learning to speak the basic Welsh needed in relation to their job should be seen as part of their training and paid for in company time.
- Defend majority Welsh-speaking communities in rural areas through a council house building programme and job creation to allow people to remain living in their local communities if they wish.

Towards a Socialist Wales

- For a new mass party of the working class.
- The Senedd to be given full legislative and financial powers, including powers to take over firms threatening redundancy.
- Take into public ownership the top companies that control the Welsh economy, under democratic workers control and management. Compensation only on the basis of proven need.
- Tax the super-rich. For a socialist government to take into public ownership the top 150 companies and banks that dominate the British economy, and run them under democratic working-class control and management. Compensation to be paid only on the basis of proven need.
- For a socialist Wales as part of a voluntary socialist federation with England, Scotland and Ireland.
- No to imperialist wars and occupations. For mass trade union action to stop arming the Israeli state
- A democratic socialist plan of production based on the interests of the overwhelming majority of people, and in a way that safeguards the environment.